

little new to the table. Apple, however, is hard at work on Leopard at present and it is widely expected that it will leave Windows Vista biting the dust.

When Steve Jobs gave a preview of ten features that would be included in Leopard at WWDC 2006 (World Wide Developers' Conference), he started off by saying that there was some stuff in Leopard he could not reveal. "There are some 'top secret' features to Leopard that we're going to keep a little close to the vest and not going to show you today; we just want you to know they are there! We don't want our friends (*clearly referring to Microsoft*) to start their photocopiers any sooner than they have to and so we're going to keep a few things a little secret." Let's hope these top secret features turn out to be worthy of the hype around them. Here's a rundown of the ten features we know are definitely going to be there in Leopard.

5.6.1 64-bit Applications

The first feature of Leopard is support for 64-bit applications. In Tiger, there was support for 64-bit at the UNIX layer and that means that the Mac Pros ship with support for UNIX, because those Mac Pros are based on a 64-bit Intel architecture. But in Leopard, this support will be taken a giant leap forward. The 64-bit support is going to be extended all the way up through the UI frameworks, Carbon and Cocoa, right to the applications. This means, in Leopard, there will be fully native 64-bit UI Carbon and Cocoa applications. And this will be done in a completely 32-bit compatible way. So the same frameworks that support 32-bit will also support 64-bit. That means 32-bit applications can be run side by side with 64-bit applications. None of these applications will be emulated or translated; they will all run natively. There will be full 64-bit support, top to bottom.

5.6.2 Time Machine

Time Machine will automatically back up your Mac. So if your hard drive dies, you can buy a new hard drive, put it in your machine and be right where you were before that hard drive died.